

# 2023

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阅读 C

## 狗或许能读懂人的意图

说明文 · 动物与科学 · 全文 396 词 · 逐句精读

<sup>1</sup> Getting the “side-eye” look from your dog can make it seem like they are making a judgement about you, and some new studies suggest they really could be.

自家狗狗“斜眼”看你时，你可能会觉得它好像在评判你，而一些新研究表明，它或许真的是在评判你。

side-eye n. 斜眼一瞥（表示怀疑、不满的眼神）

make it seem like 让人觉得好像

make a judgement about 对……做出评判

suggest v. 表明；显示

<sup>2</sup> The ability to **judge** others' **intentions** is an **indicator** of **possessing** “**theory of mind**”, which was once **thought to** be **unique to** humans.

能够判断他人的意图，是具备“心理理论”的一个标志，而心理理论一度被认为是人类所独有的。

**judge** v. 判断

**intention** n. 意图

**indicator** n. 标志；指标

**possess** v. 拥有；具备

**theory of mind** 心理理论（理解他人心理状态的能力）

**be thought to** 被认为……

**be unique to** 为……所独有

<sup>3</sup> However, new studies have shown that dogs can **read** human **behaviour** and **have a preference for** people who are more friendly or **generous with** food.

然而，新研究表明，狗能够读懂人的行为，而且偏爱更友善或给吃的更大方的人。

**read** v. 读懂；看懂

**behaviour** n. 行为

**have a preference for** 偏爱；更喜欢

**be generous with** 在……方面大方

<sup>4</sup> One such study **published** in 2023 **aimed to** see if dogs can **tell the difference between** humans who are “**unwilling**” and those who are “**unable**” to give them a **treat**.

2023年发表的一项此类研究旨在弄清，狗能否区分“不愿意”给它们零食的人和“无法”给它们零食的人。

**publish** v. 发表

**aim to** 旨在；力求

**tell the difference between** 区分；辨别

**unwilling** adj. 不愿意的

**unable** adj. 不能的；无法的

**treat** n. 零食；（给动物的）奖励食物

<sup>5</sup> Ninety-six dogs were **involved in** both “unwilling” and “unable” **scenarios** (情境) **designed** for the study.

96只狗都参与了为这项研究设计的“不愿意”和“无法”两种情境的测试。

**be involved in** 参与

**scenario** n. 情境；场景

**design** v. 设计

<sup>6</sup> Both scenarios **involved** a dog being **placed** **on one side of** a glass **screen** with small **holes** in it at **nose-height**, and an **experimenter** standing on the other.

两种情境都是把一只狗安置在一块玻璃隔板的一侧，隔板上与狗鼻子齐高的位置开有一些小孔，一名实验者则站在隔板的另一侧。

**involve** v. 包含；涉及

**place** v. 放置；安置

**on one side of** 在……的一侧

**screen** n. 隔板；屏风

**hole** n. 孔；洞

**nose-height** n. 鼻子的高度

**experimenter** n. 实验者

<sup>7</sup> In the “unwilling” scenario, the experimenter would **hang** a piece of **sausage** in front of the screen **in a** “**teasing**” (戏耍的) **manner**, and **approach** one of the holes.

在“不愿意”情境中，实验者会以“戏耍”的方式把一块香肠悬在隔板前，并靠近其中一个小孔。

**hang** v. 悬挂；吊

**sausage** n. 香肠

**in a...manner** 以……的方式

**teasing** adj. 戏耍的；逗弄的

**approach** v. 靠近；接近

<sup>8</sup> But instead of passing it through the hole to the dog, they would then pull it out of the dog's reach.

但实验者随后并没有把香肠从孔中递给狗，而是把它拿开，让狗够不着。

instead of 而不是

pass v. 递；传递

pull v. 拉开；拿走

out of one's reach 在……够不着的地方

<sup>9</sup> For the “unable” scenario, the experimenter would again move the treat **towards** the hole while the dog watched, but “**accidentally**” **drop** it before they could **pass** it **through**.

在“无法”情境中，实验者同样会在狗的注视下把零食移向小孔，但在递过去之前“不小心”让它掉了下去。

**towards** prep. 朝；向

**accidentally** adv. 意外地；不小心

**drop** v. 使掉落

**pass...through** 使穿过；递过去

<sup>10</sup> The researchers **observed** that the dogs were much more **patient**, **making more eye contact** and staying closer to the screen after the “unable” scenario **played out**.

研究人员观察到，“无法”情境结束后，狗要耐心得多：眼神交流更多，也待得离隔板更近。

**observe** v. 观察到；注意到

**patient** adj. 有耐心的

**make eye contact** 进行眼神交流

**play out** （事情）发生；展开

<sup>11</sup> In the “unwilling” scenario, however, the dogs looked at the experimenter less often and sat, lay down and wandered around more frequently.

然而在“不愿意”情境中，狗看实验者的次数更少，而坐下、趴下和四处走动则更频繁。

less often 次数更少；不那么经常

lie down 躺下；趴下

wander around 四处走动；闲逛

frequently adv. 频繁地；经常

<sup>12</sup> Another study from 2021 **tested for** “theory of mind” in dogs in a **similar** way, but the dogs were able to **walk round** the screen to **obtain** the treat after **witnessing** the experimenter’s “unwilling” or “unable” behaviour.

2021年的另一项研究以类似的方式检测狗是否具备“心理理论”，不过在这项研究中，狗在目睹实验者“不愿意”或“无法”的行为之后，可以绕过隔板去拿零食。

**test for** 检测；测试（是否存在）

**similar** adj. 相似的；类似的

**walk round** 绕过

**obtain** v. 获得；得到

**witness** v. 目睹；亲眼看见

13 The main **finding** was that the dogs **approached** the experimenter **significantly** sooner in the unable scenario than in the unwilling scenario.

主要发现是：与“不愿意”情境相比，狗在“无法”情境中明显更早地走近实验者。

**finding** n. 发现；研究结果

**approach** v. 走近；靠近

**significantly** adv. 明显地；显著地

14 However, the researchers of the 2023 study **argued** that the food dropped on the **floor** in the **clumsy** (笨拙的) manner might have **motivated** the dogs to approach the experimenter, **considering** that they **probably** often obtain food dropped on the floor in their **daily lives**.

不过，2023年那项研究的研究人员认为，考虑到狗在日常生活中很可能常常能吃到掉在地上的食物，实验者笨手笨脚弄掉在地上的食物可能是促使狗走近实验者的原因。

**argue** v. 认为；主张

**floor** n. 地面；地板

**clumsy** adj. 笨拙的

**motivate** v. 促使；激发

**considering** conj. 考虑到；鉴于

**probably** adv. 很可能

**daily life** 日常生活

<sup>15</sup> Now, more **evidence** has been **provided** that dogs **distinguish between** similar actions **associated with** different **intentions**.

如今，已有更多证据表明，狗会区分与不同意图相关的相似行为。

**evidence** n. 证据

**provide** v. 提供

**distinguish between** 区分；辨别

**be associated with** 与……相关

**intention** n. 意图

<sup>16</sup> But how **exactly** they **acquire** such **intention-reading abilities** will be an **exciting topic** for future research.

但狗究竟是如何获得这种解读意图的能力的，将会是未来研究中一个令人兴奋的课题。

**exactly** adv. 究竟；确切地

**acquire** v. 获得；习得

**intention-reading** adj. 解读意图的

**ability** n. 能力

**exciting** adj. 令人兴奋的

**topic** n. 话题；课题